Tech Valley Game Space

TVGS

Board Meeting Minutes

This meeting of the Tech Valley Game Space Board of Directors was held on Monday, Aug 10, 2026 .

The following members of the board were in attendance via teleconference:

- Taro Omiya (Chair of the Board)
- Tom Carmona (Vice-Chair, Treasurer)
- Jamey Stevenson (Executive Director)
- Jordan Faas-Bush (Secretary)

Meeting duration: 1:30

The board has a quorum at 6:02 pm.

The board pulled out the July minutes as a separate agenda item to make sure that sections relevant to ongoing negotiations are ready for release.

Chair Taro reviews the consent agenda. Tom motioned to approve, Jamey seconded. The consent agenda was approved.

The public minutes from the June meeting have been approved.

Moved on to the Questar contract discussion agenda item.

Tom has a meeting on Thursday to begin the re-negotiation. It seems like everyone is on the same page in that we don't want to re-write the agreement, just to figure out the number of hours. Come Thursday Tom expects to have an update for the board about the number of hours for the Questar contract and to start drafting the necessary paperwork next week.

For reference on this Jamey noted. He doesn't intend to do that personally if the approved hours are fewer than 500. He also reiterates that the board should split its approval of the Questar contract from its approval of Jamey being the one to teach it. Perhaps Jamey simply provides instructional support instead of taking the lead.

Jamey expects he will want to wind down his role as the main instructor in the next few years. He could still be a supporting instructor for future transition years. Questar or TVGS

could find alternative instructor(s), and we do have a network of possible instructors. In the past couple of years of the class we haven't had clarity on the number of hours and the support for co-instructors. That lack of clarity and delay has caused issues with TVGS' relationship with several co-instructors who have previously been staunch supporters.

Jamey and Tom will discuss possible budget constraints before the meeting.

Previous problems with the negotiations have included the fact that Jamey has brought up several things to the leadership at Questar repeatedly and has felt like they have not addressed them.

Jamey also notes that we should consider treating the TVGS developed curriculum as separate from the teaching. In the past they're free but that's not a guarantee.

There is also a space in the existing contract for licensing fees so we could do it by just changing the number away from $0 rather than having to draw up a full contract. It also allows for zero consultants should that be the path we take. That said, we may have to come up with a separate contract eventually. Tom will double check but is very confident that that is how it is written currently.

One of Jamey's personal goals is to keep developing and expanding those curriculum materials and pushing forwards on TVGS' educational partnerships.

6:38 Moving on to the MOU with TVCoG discussion topic. Jamey has been looking to find the most recent version and has asked Dan from TVCoG to send what he thought was the latest version on his end, but we haven't yet received that from them.

Jamey shared discussion notes from previous messages on the topic.

As long as those main discussion points about number of members with access, access swapping frequency, and creating the draft version while updating it are covered, then the agreement should be fine.

Action item will be to reach back out to Dan from TVCoG about sending an updated version of that or re-sending us the latest version they have.

6:45 Moving on to 518 gamechangers discussion.

Jamey taught a middle-school class at the Albany recreation center.

Gina Torres has emailed us saying they secured some funds as part of a Hopeworks program where they want some of our lesson content about game development into a learning management system that they run to be a self paced learning program. The target audience matches our goal of helping more people develop games so it seems like a good match.

In the very near future we will be having a meeting with them, and that would mean discussing payment as well as what work needs to be done to get the curriculum ready for public use. There is the work about updating lessons as needed and getting them into the LMS (Learning Management System), and then the licensing fees since we'd still be retaining ownership of the materials regardless of if they're included in the LMS. We believe there is clarity on their part that we'd still be retaining ownership of the materials but we'll have to make sure that the copyright is clear and evaluate the charge for use is clear.

Tom will help Jamey with some of the negotiations and legal portions. He also wants to get Darryl and Laquana's opinion on it since he thinks it will be very valuable.

We should also try to estimate how much time it will take to get everything into the system.

More broadly they may want curricula for general software development, mobile development, and web development and presumably artificial intelligence systems. It's possible we could contribute to those curricula, although that would be more work.

Jamey does wonder if we can ask for a little more visibility as part of our partnership. TVGS has been involved in the planning since the beginning, we didn't develop the idea and they have secured the funding and venues, but we have taught the classes and brought the curriculum. That is one thing worth considering for the future. This past week they posted and mentioned every other partner but us. For negotiations it's worth figuring out if they view us as a contractor who they may swap out, or what the nature of the partnership is.

This is the type of program that Jamey wishes to do in the future although he feels we don't currently have the fundraising skills to do so, but they've actually been raising funds based on our experience. But potentially we could in the future do more self lead programs where we're the ones garnering the funding and people come out of it knowing about us. That is a note for the 1-3-5 year planning.

The timeline is between now and October 31st so we don't have much time. Capacity will be tough especially depending on how Questar shakes out and how much time Jamey has to contribute and we may need to spread out the work.

Next steps and action items are that Jamey is trying to schedule a meeting in the next two weeks and Jamey will update the board about what comes out of that.

The Review the MOU contract agenda item is that 518 needed a contract for the previous program, which we reviewed and signed prior to the previous program in order to make sure that TVGS got paid and the funding went through.

Action Item: The contract will be put onto the board shared drive, but it should be the same as the previous one.

7:10 CoE grant:

The biggest problem is that we needed assistance for reporting and summarizing our budget. Jamey does not expect to need that help now that the 518 program is done and Tom has already assisted by sending information over.

Jamey has several budget priorities for the grant. He'd like to have a draft sub-award budget by the next board meeting based on these priorities.

- Executive Director salary (increase total hours to be full-time)
- Website overhaul
- Curriculum development for a production and/or bizdev focused class unit
- Bringing back Lift Off diversity incubator program
- Bringing back ProtoStar prototyping fund and game pitch competition
- Equipment upgrades for TVGS coworking office (?)

Additional suggestions:

- [Taro]
    - Any strategy to improve volunteer recruitment
    - Budget use for more in-person events, especially showcases/playtesting sessions

Jordan and Jamey will hopefully meet to discuss coordinating for TVGS events.

BatGirl is trying to do a quarterly "creator's gameplay night" and there is also the Semicolon showcase event. Jamey and Jordan can also schedule a call with Dan from TVCoG about setting up potential events.

7:29 Taro requested all the board members fill out their survey on the state of TVGS and the goals for TVGS for the future. The deadline for the survey is a week before the next board meeting since Taro needs to summarize it for the board meeting.

Tom motions to adjourn the meeting. Motion is seconded by Jamey and Jordan. Motion is approved.

Meeting has been adjourned at 7:32 PM EDT.

Jordan Faas-Bush

TVGS Secretary of the Board